

Whistlebird Ltd — food and drink recall policy

- **Created and effective:** 23 September 2026
- **Updated:** 30 September 2026, so that both decision makers have equal authority
- **Recall decision makers:** Johnny Dempsey and Nikolai Scott. They have equal authority. Either of them can make and authorise a recall decision, and neither needs the other's approval to act.
- **Review:** at least every 12 months, after a recall or mock recall, and when products, suppliers, distribution or MPI guidance change.

This procedure applies to Whistlebird's ingredients, work in progress and bottled spirits. It covers a problem Whistlebird discovers and a recall notified by a supplier. Protect consumers first; act on a credible concern while facts are still being gathered. Record the time, source and nature of every report, every decision and the person making it.

1. Investigate and contain immediately

The person receiving a complaint, test result, production finding or supplier notice tells Johnny or Nikolai immediately. Whichever of them is told starts the response and tells the other. Stop using or dispatching possibly affected material. Identify and physically segregate stock on site, label it **ON HOLD — DO NOT USE OR SELL**, and prevent its release. If a supplier recalls an ingredient or packaging component, identify all receipts and finished batches that used it; follow the supplier's instructions while assessing Whistlebird's own finished products.

Use purchase and supplier lot records, production steps, inventory movements, bottle or batch IDs, Xero sales allocations and customer contacts to trace both backwards to inputs and forwards to every affected batch and recipient. Include products already shipped, on hand, in transit, used as samples or otherwise disposed of. Record quantities and any unknown destinations. Ask trade customers or logistics providers to hold affected stock promptly when that could limit exposure.

2. Inform and assess

Contact the NP3 verifier as soon as practicable; if unavailable, contact New Zealand Food Safety (NZFS) on **0800 00 83 33** or **Food.Recalls@mpi.govt.nz**. Give the known product, batch, hazard, distribution and hold details; update them as the investigation progresses. Seek NZFS advice promptly if scope or risk is uncertain.

Johnny or Nikolai, working with the other and any relevant production, sales or communications staff, documents a risk assessment: product and intended consumer, hazard and likely harm, affected lots and dates, source and time window, quantity and current location, distribution, and any uncertainty. Use MPI's food recall risk assessment form. Decide and record the reason for one of these actions:

- **Consumer-level recall** when unsafe product may have reached consumers: remove it from trade and notify consumers.
- **Trade-level recall** when affected product has not reached consumers, or NZFS advises that this level is appropriate for a suitability issue: remove it from the supply chain.
- **No recall / withdrawal** only when the assessment shows recall is unnecessary; document and resolve the problem. A cosmetic issue alone may warrant a trade withdrawal.

Take a cautious approach, especially for vulnerable consumers. Either Johnny or Nikolai can authorise the decision. If they disagree, the more cautious option applies until NZFS has given advice. Neither of them may release held stock until its safety and suitability are established and the release is recorded.

3. Check the decision and communicate

For a real recall, tell NZFS **as soon as practicable and no later than 24 hours after the recall decision**. Provide the affected product and reason, send the risk assessment, and check the proposed recall level and product management or disposal plan with NZFS. Record who was contacted, when, and the advice received. Follow any shorter deadline or direction NZFS gives. If product was exported, check and follow the applicable export notification rules as well.

Tell every affected business customer which products and batches to stop selling, isolate or return; request confirmation and quantity held. For a consumer-level recall, coordinate a point-of-sale notice with NZFS before distribution and use appropriate direct contact, website, social media and other channels to reach consumers. State product identification, risk, what consumers should do and how to obtain help or a refund. Keep copies and timestamps of all communications.

Keep returned stock segregated. Decide with NZFS whether it will be safely disposed of, returned, reworked or relabelled; document the basis for any rework or relabelling, the authorisation, quantities and final disposition. Do not put affected stock back on sale on an unverified assumption.

4. Reconcile, audit and close

Reconcile the amount produced or received against stock on site, in transit, quality samples, amounts sold to each customer, amounts returned or destroyed and amounts unaccounted for. Chase missing responses and record remaining exposure. Review the response, root cause, customer reach and timing; assign corrective and preventive actions, owners and due dates. Send the recall audit information to NZFS or the assigned case officer and retain its feedback. Close the case only when actions and disposition are recorded.

Keep the report, risk assessment, trace and quantity reconciliation, hold and disposal records, communications, decision log, audit and corrective actions with the NP3 evidence. Record any related staff training in the staff competency register.

5. Test the procedure

Run a simulated recall at least every 12 months, unless a genuine recall in that period demonstrated that traceability and recall procedures were effective. Design a realistic worst-case scenario, preferably a consumer-level recall, and involve both decision makers and anyone who handles production, sales or communications. A different person should design the scenario where practical. Work through investigation, hold, trace, risk assessment, decision, draft NZFS and customer communications, draft point-of-sale notice when applicable, reconciliation and corrective actions. Mark all exercise documents **SIMULATED RECALL**. Do not send draft recall notices or notify NZFS as though the exercise were real. Keep the scenario, timeline, records, findings and action owners for the verifier. If the exercise ends with no recall, run another scenario that tests a recall decision.

MPI references

- [How to do a simulated \(mock\) food recall](#) — annual exercise, scenario, records and review.

- [Food recall guidance for businesses](#) — real recall decision and six-step response.
- [Food recall documents](#) — risk assessment, audit and notice templates.